CHAPTER 08

Take responsibility for the vehicle and load

Permission to drive, technical capacity and actual loading are separate checks. Passing one does not mean the others are satisfied.

In this chapter

M08-L01 · Understand what you may drive

M08-L02 · Make the load part of the safety check

M08-L03 · Keep the car legally ready

M08-L04 · Know what assistance cannot do

M08-R · Review and self-assessment

Answers and review guidance

Official references

This material is a learning aid to help you understand Swedish driving theory. It is not an official source and cannot replace official information from Trafikverket and Transportstyrelsen. Always consult their current guidance and the applicable rules.

M08-L01

Understand what you may drive

Your goal: Use entitlement and vehicle information to assess a car or trailer combination.

Requirements. Ordinary category B permits a passenger car or light goods vehicle with a total weight of no more than 3,500 kg. For trailers, either the trailer's total weight is at most 750 kg, or, if above 750 kg, the car and trailer's combined total weights must not exceed 3,500 kg. The first route can therefore permit a combination up to 4,250 kg; it does not mean every 4,250 kg combination is permitted on ordinary B. Category B · Car with trailer

Extended B (B96) permits combined total weights up to 4,250 kg, without increasing the car's 3,500 kg limit. Under the ordinary current BE rule, the towing car is still limited to 3,500 kg total weight and the trailer or trailers may have combined total weights up to 3,500 kg. Older entitlements and conditions can differ; check the individual licence rather than applying a current-new-licence example to everyone. This book is not a full B96 or BE course. Trailer entitlement guide

Two tests. Entitlement uses registered total weights. Technical towing limits also restrict what the particular car may pull in its actual loaded state. Emptying a trailer may reduce its actual weight without changing its registered total weight, so it may solve a technical-weight problem but not an entitlement problem. Towing weights

Vehicle comparison · Light lorry without a trailer. A light lorry (lätt lastbil) has a registered total weight of at most 3,500 kg. Without a trailer, it normally follows the road's maximum speed; the general heavy-lorry cap does not apply. A heavy lorry exceeds 3,500 kg: without a trailer its vehicle maximum is 90 km/h on a motorway or expressway, and 80 km/h on other roads; with a trailer it is 80 km/h. A lower road limit always applies. For a light lorry towing, check the combination rules in M08-L02. Transportstyrelsen: light and heavy lorries

Apply the limit. A light lorry without a trailer on a road signed 100 km/h does not acquire an 80 km/h cap simply because it is called a lorry. Still reduce speed for visibility, grip, traffic and load; a maximum is not a target. Safe-speed duty, chapter 3 §14

Two separate checks

Hypothetical registered total weights: 2,200 kg + 1,500 kg = 3,700 kg. Check entitlement and technical limits separately. The pictured vehicle does not establish its capacity.

Worked decision. A car has a total weight of 2,200 kg and a trailer 1,500 kg. Their combined total weight is 3,700 kg, and the trailer exceeds 750 kg. Ordinary B does not cover this combination. B96 may satisfy the entitlement part, but the car's towing capacity and loaded weights still need checking.

Check your understanding

Knowledge check. (1) Is ordinary B automatically excluded for a 3,500 kg car and 750 kg trailer? (2) Which maximum normally applies to a light lorry without a trailer, and is it a target?

Remember: Check the licence first, then the vehicle and load—not one instead of the other.

M08-L02

Make the load part of the safety check

Your goal: Distinguish weight terms and assess securing, capacity and trailer suitability.

Term	Meaning for this lesson
Tjänstevikt	Vehicle in its defined ready-for-use state; a car's figure includes the driver, while a trailer's does not include cargo.
Totalvikt	Registered maximum weight, built from the defined unladen/ready weight and maximum load.
Bruttovikt	Actual weight transmitted to the road at that time.
Maximilast	Total weight minus the defined ready weight: the maximum passenger/cargo load.

Use the official definitions when reading registration data. Do not count the driver twice in an exercise that starts from a car's defined tjänstevikt, and do not assume a paper figure measures the load you have actually added. Weight definitions

Weight restrictions and vehicle symbols

These are independent reference examples. Distinguish actual gross weight, combination weight and axle loads from a registered-weight qualifier. Vehicle symbols are shown separately; they are not a combined sign assembly.

C20 · Maximum gross weight of a vehicle

Begränsad bruttovikt på fordon

The displayed value limits the vehicle's actual gross weight, not its registered maximum weight. 12 tonnes.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C21 · Maximum gross weight of a vehicle or combination

Begränsad bruttovikt på fordon och fordonståg

The displayed value limits the actual gross weight of the vehicle or combination. 30 tonnes with a vehicle-and-trailer pictogram.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C23 · Maximum axle load

Begränsat axeltryck

Do not exceed the displayed load on an axle. 6 tonnes on an axle.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

C24 · Maximum bogie load

Begränsat boggitryck

The displayed limit applies to the bogie load, not the weight of the whole vehicle. 10 tonnes on a bogie.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C46 · Maximum triple-axle load

Begränsat trippelaxeltryck

Do not exceed the displayed load on the triple-axle group. 20 tonnes on a triple-axle group.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

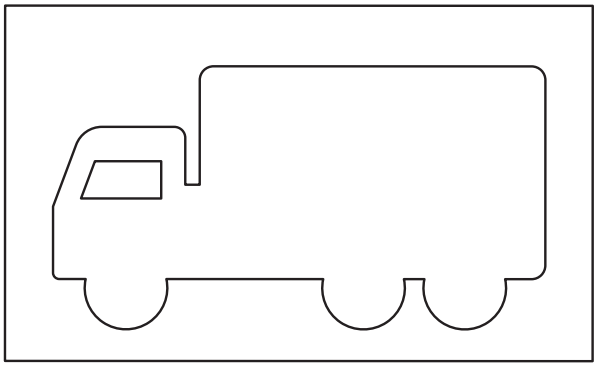
T5 · Maximum authorised weight threshold

Totalvikt

The main sign applies to vehicles whose registered maximum authorised weight (totalvikt) exceeds this value. Do not confuse it with actual gross weight. Maximum authorised weight threshold 3.5 tonnes.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

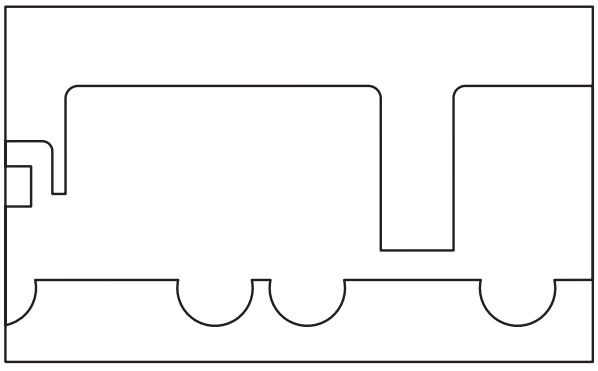


S1 · Heavy goods vehicle symbol

Tung lastbil

This symbol identifies heavy goods vehicles when used in a sign or panel. Its surrounding instruction supplies the restriction or permission.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



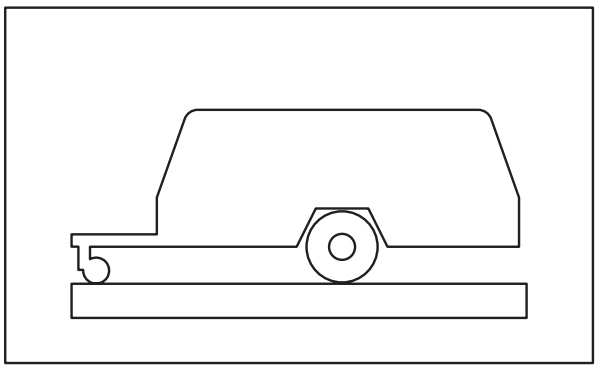
S2 · Heavy goods vehicle with trailer symbol

Tung lastbil med tillkopplad släpvagn

This symbol identifies a heavy goods vehicle with an attached trailer. Read it together with the main instruction.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

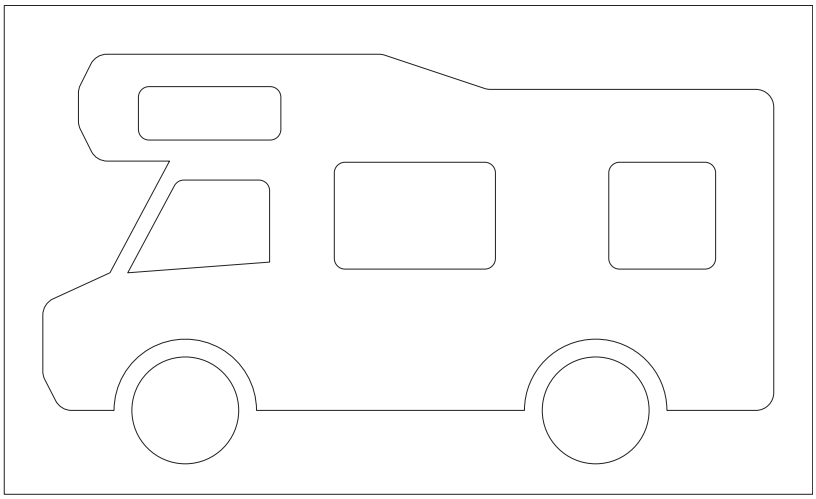


S9 · Centre-axle trailer symbol

Släpkärra

This symbol identifies a släpkärra. Read its role from the surrounding sign or panel.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



S12 · Class II passenger car symbol

Personbil klass II

This identifies a personbil klass II, the Swedish vehicle class used for motorhomes. It does not mean every vehicle used for camping.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

Requirements. Keep within the car's permitted trailer weight and maximum actual combined weight as well as each vehicle's limits. Registration fields O.1/O.2 identify relevant braked/unbraked trailer limits; F.3 identifies the maximum combined actual weight. Missing or unclear data needs resolution before towing. Towing weights

Secure cargo so it cannot endanger people, fall, drag, obstruct control or obscure required lights and signals. Put heavy items low and suitably supported, and follow the equipment's rated load and securing instructions. A roof box is not permission to exceed a roof or vehicle limit. Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§78–81 · Safe loading

Projecting cargo needs separate checks. Mark cargo extending ahead or more than 1 m behind, with the specified exception for clearly visible front projection below 1 m. Darkness or poor visibility requires the prescribed lamps and reflectors, white forward and red rearward. Marking does not authorise an otherwise prohibited width, length or load. Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§82–83 and chapter 4 §§15–17

On roads other than private roads, the ordinary width/load rule restricts a motor vehicle or its trailer if the load projects more than 20 cm beyond either side, or the overall width including load exceeds 260 cm. The general length ceiling for a non-bus vehicle or combination is 24.0 m including load; special regimes and exemptions exist. Do not treat those general ceilings as permission to exceed a lower vehicle, route or sign limit. Special oversized transport needs its own verification. Traffic Regulation, chapter 4 §§15–17

Dimensions and bearing capacity

Independent examples distinguish width, height, length, a width plate and bearing-capacity classes. A general vehicle limit does not override a lower signed restriction.

C16 · Maximum vehicle width

Begränsad fordonsbredd

Vehicles wider than the displayed limit may not pass. Assess the actual width, including the load. Width 2.2 metres.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C17 · Maximum vehicle height

Begränsad fordonshöjd

Vehicles higher than the displayed limit may not pass. The sign is used for restricted clearance below 4.5 metres. Height 3.5 metres.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C18 · Maximum vehicle or combination length

Begränsad fordonslängd

Do not pass with a vehicle or combination longer than the displayed limit. Length 20 metres, with a vehicle-and-trailer pictogram.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

T4 · Available width

Fri bredd

Read the stated clear width together with the main sign. It is not permission to exceed a separate vehicle-width limit. Available width 3.5 metres.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C22 · Road bearing-capacity class

Bärighetsklass

The displayed class identifies the road's bearing-capacity regime. Check the applicable axle and weight limits for your vehicle. BK3, the displayed bearing-capacity class.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C22-2 · Road bearing-capacity class

Bärighetsklass

The displayed class identifies the road's bearing-capacity regime. Check the applicable axle and weight limits for your vehicle. BK2, the displayed bearing-capacity class.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

For a conventional light braked trailer with rigid drawbar and suitable overrun brake, the maximum is normally 80 km/h. For an unbraked trailer up to 750 kg, 80 km/h requires its total weight to be no more than half the car’s defined ready weight; when the trailer is empty, its ready weight is used for this comparison instead. The ordinary unbraked combination outside those conditions is limited to 40 km/h, subject to the other combination requirements; other configurations can be limited to 30. Use Transportstyrelsen's calculator and guidance for the specific combination, and obey any lower road limit. Trailer guide: speed conditions · Traffic Regulation, chapter 4 §20, version applicable on 1 October 2026

Trailer access and vehicle symbols

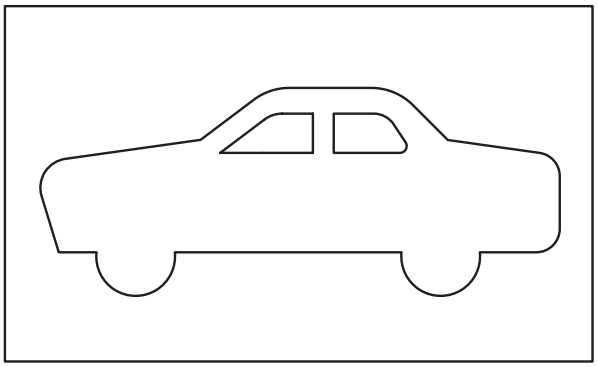
C6 controls access for the specified trailer combinations; it does not set a speed limit. The vehicle symbols are independent references, not additions to the pictured C6 sign.

C6 · Restriction on motor vehicles towing trailers

Förbud mot trafik med motordrivet fordon med tillkopplad släpvagn

The basic prohibition excludes semi-trailers and centre-axle trailers (släpkärror). A panel may extend it to those types or specify a trailer-weight threshold. Trailer crossed by a red diagonal.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



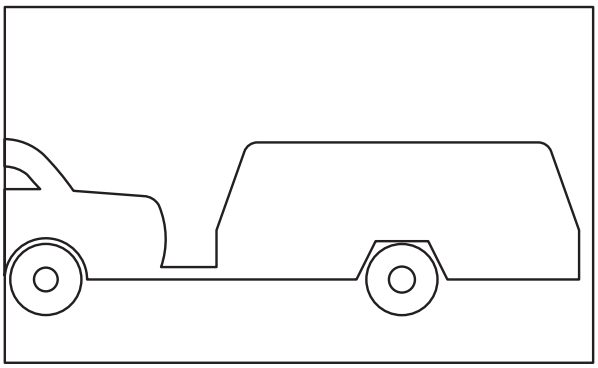
S3 · Passenger car symbol

Personbil

This symbol identifies passenger cars in the surrounding sign or panel.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning



S4 · Passenger car with centre-axle trailer symbol

Personbil med tillkopplad släpkärra

This identifies a passenger car towing a släpkärra. Do not use it as a universal illustration of every trailer classification.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Check coupling load

Towball load · A separate force. Towball load (kultryck) is the trailer's downward load at the coupling, not the trailer's whole loaded weight. With a conventional towball behind the car's rear axle, excessive downward force acts through a lever arm: it increases rear loading while reducing the load carried by the front axle. Front unloading does not require the wheels to leave the road. With less front-tyre loading, available steering grip and response can be impaired. Official towing guide: front-wheel unloading, page 6

Trafikverket warns that incorrect coupling pressure can lift the car or trailer. Follow the specified towball, coupling, axle and vehicle limits for the actual combination; there is no universal number in this lesson. Measure and redistribute the load as instructed before travelling. Total trailer weight, coupling load and cargo securing are separate checks. Do not cure excessive downward load by guessing or creating an equally unsuitable load distribution. Trafikverket: coupling-load caution · Official towing guide: ratings and load distribution

Worked loading decision. Your total trailer weight is within the car's towing limit, but a heavy object far forward makes the coupling load excessive. The total-weight check has not proved suitable axle loading. Stop preparation, establish the specified limits and adjust and secure the load before driving.

Know the actual load

Hypothetical loading calculation: 400 kg ready weight + 500 kg cargo = 900 kg actual weight. Example towing limit: 800 kg. The goods are beside the trailer for planning; this is not a secured-load demonstration.

Worked decision. A trailer's ready weight is 400 kg and cargo adds 500 kg, giving an illustrative actual weight of 900 kg. A car rated to tow only 800 kg cannot pull that load merely because the driver's entitlement covers the registered total weights.

Check your understanding

Knowledge check. (1) Does a strap prove the vehicle is within its weight limit? (2) Can an acceptable total trailer weight still conceal excessive towball load, and what can that do?

Remember: Establish what the load weighs, where it is, how it is restrained and what limits apply.

M08-L03

Keep the car legally ready

Your goal: Build an ownership checklist for registration, insurance, inspection and vehicle status.

Requirements. The registered owner of an on-road car must have compulsory motor insurance. Not using the car, or having a defect or driving prohibition, does not by itself end that obligation; formal off-road status matters. Compulsory insurance covers specified traffic injuries and damage to others, not every loss to your own car. Optional cover varies by policy. Compulsory motor insurance

For an ordinary car or light goods vehicle up to 3,500 kg, the normal inspection sequence is: first by 36 months after the month of first use, second by 24 months after the first inspection month, then by 14 months after the preceding inspection month. Check the recorded date and any special category or exemption for your vehicle. An earlier inspection changes the next calculation; an old reminder is not proof of the current deadline. Inspection intervals

An on-road registration status, valid insurance and completed inspection answer different questions. Check the vehicle's status and any prohibition before use, and deal with tax obligations through the current official service. A car being physically driveable does not establish legal readiness. On-road and off-road status

Ownership process. Transportstyrelsen currently provides eligible private-person transfers through Mina sidor; other cases may require the latest registration certificate part 2. The service has eligibility conditions. Consult the current instructions instead of relying on an old app or a remembered screen sequence. Part 1 and the vehicle enquiry service provide technical information; protect ownership documents appropriately. Ownership transfer · Registration certificate

Resolve a missed inspection

Inspection deadline · An automatic ban. If the required periodic inspection deadline is missed, an automatic driving ban (inträtt körförbud) applies. You remain responsible even without a reminder. Booking a later appointment does not end the ban. The deadline ban lasts until the inspection has been carried out; follow its result, since defects can bring a new prohibition or a repair/reinspection requirement. Check the vehicle record before ordinary use.
Transportstyrelsen: missed inspection · Vehicle Regulation, chapter 6 §§15–21

Restricted trips. With an overdue-inspection ban and on-road status (påställd), only the shortest suitable route to a repair workshop for repair or to an inspection business for inspection is permitted. If the vehicle is off-road (avställd) and the ban still applies, the exception is the shortest suitable route to the nearest inspection business. Traffic insurance and other applicable requirements still matter; the off-road exception requires no unpaid vehicle taxes. It does not permit errands or commuting. A prohibition issued because the vehicle is dangerously defective has different conditions: it must be recovered from the place where that prohibition is issued.
Transportstyrelsen: inspection prohibitions · Transportstyrelsen: off-road inspection conditions

Worked deadline. An ordinary light car's recorded inspection deadline is 31 October 2026. Without the required inspection, the deadline ban starts on 1 November. An appointment on 5 November does not allow normal driving on 2 November. Arrange a permitted inspection trip, or transport if it cannot be driven safely and lawfully, then follow the inspection result. These dates illustrate the rule; use the actual vehicle's record. Vehicle Regulation, chapter 6 §§15 and 21

Worked decision. A buyer collects an on-road car but assumes the seller's insurance is enough for the trip home. The buyer checks the transfer and arranges the required cover from the applicable ownership date before driving. The sale does not transfer the seller's insurance as personal cover for the buyer.

Check your understanding

Knowledge check. (1) Does garaging an on-road car automatically end compulsory insurance? (2) The inspection deadline passed, but you booked an appointment. May you commute meanwhile?

Remember: Keep a record of dates and obligations, then verify them against the current vehicle record.

M08-L04

Know what assistance cannot do

Your goal: Explain why safety systems and powertrain differences do not remove your duties to observe and control.

Trafikverket describes modern protection as including crashworthiness and systems such as lane assistance and automatic emergency braking. These functions can help, but a good safety rating is not a promise that any collision can be avoided. Recent official crash testing also shows the limits of automatic braking in severe truck-trailer collision scenarios. Crash safety · Trafikverket: braking and truck-trailer tests

ABS is anti-lock braking. It helps retain the ability to develop steering and braking forces together, within available friction. Stability control reduces the risk of skid crashes; it does not create extra road grip or excuse excessive speed. The driver still has to maintain control and an appropriate speed. VTI friction report, section 4.3 · Trafikverket: tyre and stability advice · Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §14

Powertrain awareness. A plug-in hybrid can operate on electricity and with a combustion engine. That difference matters when interpreting fuel use and emissions: do not assume that every journey is electrically powered. Transportstyrelsen: plug-in hybrids

For the actual vehicle, establish how it becomes ready to move, how drive and reverse are selected, how it is secured, and what warnings or assistance limitations need attention. Do not transfer a universal gear-change, engine-speed, coasting or brake-check recipe between manual, automatic, hybrid and electric vehicles. Vehicle-specific procedures need the vehicle's own instructions and practical teaching. The curriculum's role is to help you identify those questions, not guess their answers.

Assistance has limits

The driver follows the temporary road path and remains responsible for control. The left marker bands slope down towards the road; the right markers slope down the opposite way. Official X3 artwork: Transportstyrelsen. Simplified scene, not to scale.

Transportstyrelsen · X3 official description

Worked decision. A driver assumes lane assistance will handle a temporary roadworks layout. Instead, they must read the actual signs and lane path, stay in control and understand the system's limitations. An assistance symbol does not transfer responsibility for the route.

Check your understanding

Knowledge check. Does an anti-lock system guarantee a short stop on every surface?

Remember: Know what the system assists, what it cannot guarantee and what remains your task.

Review and self-assessment

Scenario: You borrow a car and trailer for a move. You know the registration numbers but not the actual load weight or towing limit.

A borrowed car and trailer await loading. Establish the missing figures and documents before deciding to drive. The drawing supplies no verified weight, entitlement or towing capacity.

Explain the checks required before agreeing to drive.

Keep a practice record

Identify one figure or document you do not yet know how to interpret. Record the risk of guessing and the official reference you will use. Syllabus self-assessment, chapters 2–3 §3

Review after answering

M08-L01

Answer: (1) No. The at-most-750 kg trailer route can cover it; technical/actual-weight limits still apply. (2) The road maximum, with speed reduced for conditions. It is not the general heavy-lorry cap or a target; towing needs a separate combination check.

M08-L02

Answer: (1) No. Weight and securing are separate checks; inspect coupling, lights, tyres and equipment too. (2) Yes. Excess downward load behind the rear axle can unload the front axle and impair steering grip. Check the actual coupling/axle limits and load distribution before driving.

M08-L03

Answer: (1) No. Formal status and insurance rules apply. (2) No. The automatic deadline ban continues until inspection is carried out. Only the applicable restricted inspection/repair trip is permitted; vehicle status, insurance, tax and safety conditions must be satisfied. Follow the inspection result and check for any further prohibition before ordinary use.

M08-L04

Answer: No. It operates within the friction available, and stopping still depends on speed, surface, tyres and conditions.

M08-R

Review guide: Establish entitlement, registered and actual weights, technical limits, vehicle status, insurance, inspection, coupling, tyres, lights and securing. Do not let one successful calculator result stand in for every physical check.

Official references

Original references checked 5 October 2026; G8 additions checked 13 October 2026. Sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Consult current guidance and applicable rules.

Category B

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/korkort/ta-korkort/valj-behorighet/personbil-och-latt-lastbil/b-personbil-och-latt-lastbil/

Car with trailer

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/korkort/har-korkort/fordon-du-far-kora/personbil-med-slap/

Trailer entitlement guide

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/fordonsregler/regler-for-olika-fordonsslag/slap/slapvagn-husvagn/

Towing weights

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/fordonsregler/regler-for-olika-fordonsslag/slap/vikter/

Transportstyrelsen: light and heavy lorries

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/fordonsregler/regler-for-olika-fordonsslag/personbil-lastbil-och-buss/lastbil/

Official references

Original references checked 5 October 2026; G8 additions checked 13 October 2026. Sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Consult current guidance and applicable rules.

Safe-speed duty, chapter 3 §14

https://www.riksdagen.se/sv/dokument-och-lagar/dokument/svensk-forfattningssamling/trafikforordning-19981276_sfs-1998-1276/

Weight definitions

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/fordonsregler/vikter/

Safe loading

https://www.trafikverket.se/resa-och-trafik/trafiksakerhet/sakerhet-pa-vag/sakerhet-i-bil/lasta-bilen-sakert/

Official towing guide: front-wheel unloading, page 6

https://www.oregon.gov/odot/Safety/Documents/TowingATrailer.pdf

Compulsory motor insurance

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/aga-kopa-eller-salja-fordon/trafikforsakring/

Official references

Original references checked 5 October 2026; G8 additions checked 13 October 2026. Sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Consult current guidance and applicable rules.

Inspection intervals

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/aga-kopa-eller-salja-fordon/fordonsbesiktning/besiktningsregler/personbil-och-lastbil-som-inte-overstiger-3500-kg-i-totalvikt/

On-road and off-road status

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/aga-kopa-eller-salja-fordon/stall-av-eller-pa-ditt-fordon/

Ownership transfer

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/aga-kopa-eller-salja-fordon/agarbyte/

Registration certificate

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/aga-kopa-eller-salja-fordon/registreringsbevis/

Transportstyrelsen: missed inspection

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/aga-kopa-eller-salja-fordon/fordonsbesiktning/

Official references

Original references checked 5 October 2026; G8 additions checked 13 October 2026. Sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Consult current guidance and applicable rules.

Vehicle Regulation, chapter 6 §§15–21

https://www.riksdagen.se/sv/dokument-och-lagar/dokument/svensk-forfattningssamling/fordonsforordning-2009211_sfs-2009-211/

Transportstyrelsen: off-road inspection conditions

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/aga-kopa-eller-salja-fordon/stall-av-eller-pa-ditt-fordon/stalla-av-ditt-fordon/

Crash safety

https://www.trafikverket.se/resa-och-trafik/trafiksakerhet/sakerhet-pa-vag/sakerhet-i-bil/krocksakerhet/

Trafikverket: braking and truck-trailer tests

https://www.trafikverket.se/om-oss/nyheter/nationella-nyheter/2026/juni/trafikverket-vill-se-sakrare-lastbilsslap-efter-nya-krocktester/

VTI friction report, section 4.3

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/globalassets/global/regler/jarnvag/plan-och-byggregler-for-vagar-och-sparbunden-trafik/vti-rapport-friktionsegenskaper.pdf

Official references

Original references checked 5 October 2026; G8 additions checked 13 October 2026. Sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Consult current guidance and applicable rules.

Trafikverket: tyre and stability advice

https://www.trafikverket.se/resa-och-trafik/trafiksakerhet/sakerhet-pa-vag/dack/

Transportstyrelsen: plug-in hybrids

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/om-oss/pressrum/nyhetsarkiv/2026/forandrad-viktningsfaktor-for-nya-laddhybrider/

Syllabus self-assessment, chapters 2–3 §3

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/TSFS/TSFS%202011_20.pdf

Road-sign illustrations: Transportstyrelsen. Each reference example links to its official description. Swedish names are official; English labels and explanations are editorial translations. Road scenes are simplified illustrations, not to scale.